

league for the first time since the 2003-04 Invincibles season, edged past Brighton and Hove Albion with a 2-1 win.

Captain Martin Odegaard found the net, while Georginio Rutter scored an own goal to guide the Gunners to victory.

Tijani Reijnders and Rayan Cherki found the net to give Manchester City a 2-1 win against Nottingham Forest. Ahead of the match, a minute's silence was held at the City Ground in memory of Forest legend John Robertson, who passed away at the age of 72.

The Manchester United vs Newcastle United game, the only Boxing Day fixture this season, did not offer much in terms of goals, with the Red Devils edging past the Magpies 1-0. Patrick Dorgu scored his first goal in United colours with a rifled volley to earn his team the three points.

Nineteen-year-old Archie Grey came up clutch for Tottenham Hotspur, with his strike giving the side a 1-0 win against Crystal Palace.

At the end of matchday 18, Arsenal stays top with 42 points. Manchester City (40), Aston Villa (39) and Liverpool (32) are second, third and fourth respectively. Chelsea and Manchester United are fifth and sixth, both on 29 points, while Tottenham is 11th with 25.

La Liga

Kylian Mbappe (**right**) has always been vocal about his admiration for Cristiano Ronaldo, saying he idolised the Portuguese star growing up. In Real Madrid's 2-0 win against Sevilla, Mbappe cemented a place alongside his idol as his penalty took his calendar-year tally to 59 goals, equalling the record set by Ronaldo in 2013. Jude Bellingham also scored to help Los Blancos to victory.

After Real Madrid's win, Barcelona was under pressure to collect three points as well, and Hansi Flick's men did so comfortably against Villarreal.

Lamine Yamal and Raphinha scored for the Blaugrana to ensure the club stays top heading into the new year.

